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AI



Meet the minds shaping
AI: TechCrunch Disrupt
2025 AI Stage revealed



TechCrunch Events — 7:00 AM PDT · July 28, 2025

At [TechCrunch Disrupt 2025](#), the AI Stage comes alive with the voices shaping the future of technology, creativity, and security. Top VCs reveal what it takes to win funding in a rapidly evolving landscape, as they place bets on the next wave of AI founders. Hear groundbreaking insights from leaders at visionary startups like Apptronik, ElevenLabs, Hugging Face, Runway, Wonder Dynamics, Eleven and Wayve — pioneers redefining the future of tech.

[many more](#) below, represent the future of AI. On the [AI Stage](#) at Disrupt, get an inside look at how breakthroughs are transforming industries, user experiences, and what startups and investors must know to stay ahead.

More [sessions](#) and [speakers](#) are coming soon. In the meantime, secure your ticket for Disrupt 2025 and get ready to lean into dynamic conversations happening on the AI Stage, along with four other industry stages — Space, Builders, Going Public, and Disrupt — from October 27-29 at Moscone West in San Francisco. Save up to \$675 before prices jump after July. [Register here to save big.](#)

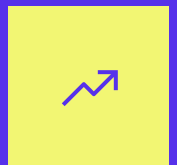
TC DISRUPT

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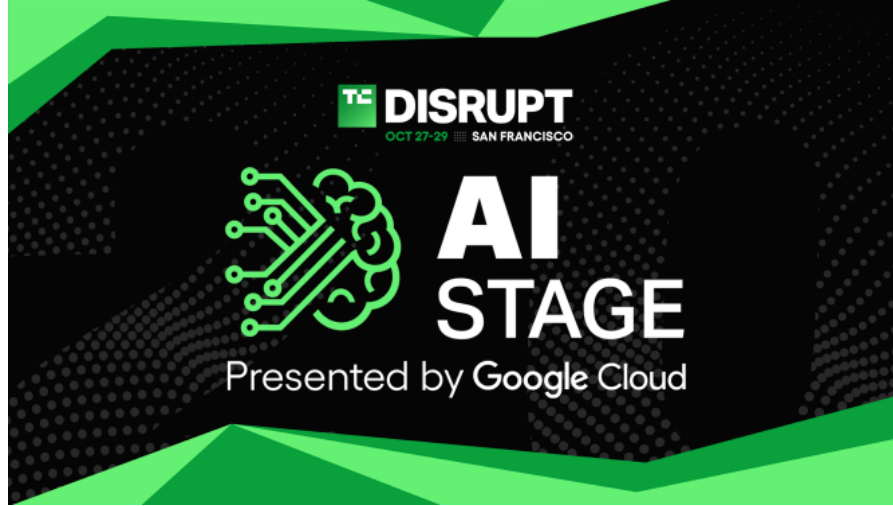
Put your brand in front of 10,000+ tech and VC leaders across all three days of Disrupt 2025. Amplify your reach, spark real connections, and lead the innovation charge. Secure your exhibit space before your competitor does.

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- Lina Khan points to Figma IPO as vindication of M&A scrutiny
- Your public ChatGPT queries are getting indexed by Google and other search engines

Introducing the AI Stage lineup

Betting on the Next Wave: What VCs Want in AI Startups

Speakers to be announced.

From model infrastructure to niche applications, AI is producing a new breed of founders and a new set of investor expectations. In this candid conversation, top VCs share what's catching their eye (and what's not), how they're thinking about defensibility in a world of AI monopolies, and what founders need to show to get that next term sheet.

Creative Machines and Where AI Meets Imagination

[Nikola Todorovic](#), co-founder and CEO, Wonder Dynamics; and more speakers to be announced

AI is no longer just optimizing workflows; it's co-creating art, media, and experiences in ways we're only beginning to understand. [Wonder Dynamics](#) CEO Nikola Todorovic joins a panel of creative technologists to explore how AI is reshaping the creative process, blurring the lines between artist and algorithm, and opening new frontiers for storytellers, designers, and dreamers alike.

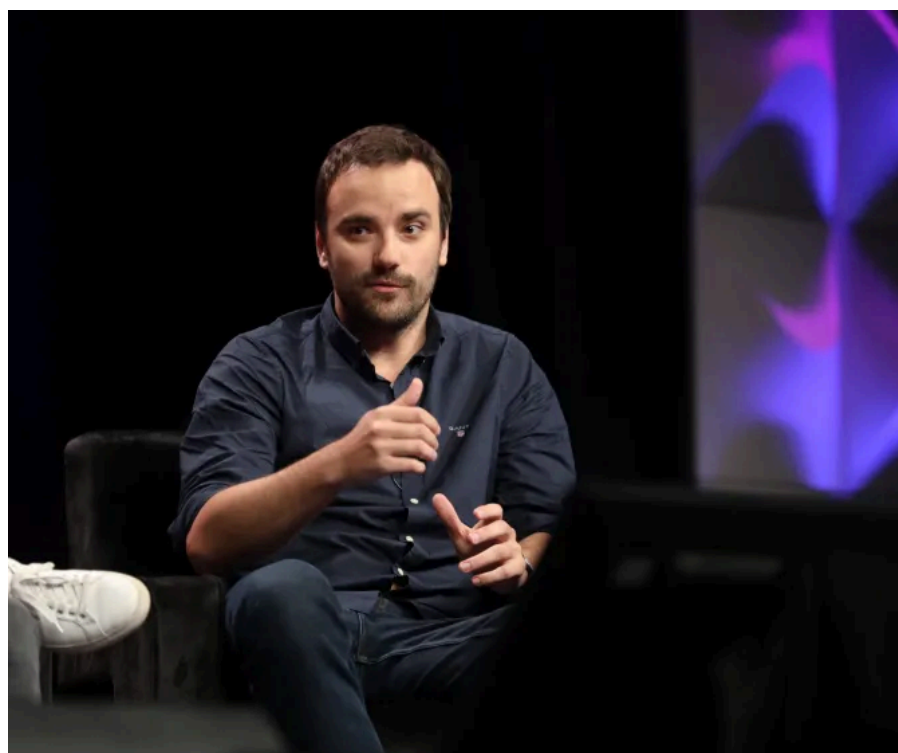


Tech and VC heavyweights join the Disrupt 2025 agenda

Netflix, ElevenLabs, Wayve, Sequoia Capital — just a few of the heavy hitters joining the Disrupt 2025 agenda. They're here to deliver the insights that fuel startup growth and sharpen your edge. Don't miss the 20th anniversary of TechCrunch Disrupt, and a chance to learn from the top voices in tech — grab your ticket now and save up to \$675 before prices rise on August 7.

San Francisco | October 27-29, 2025

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NIKOLA TODOROVIC SPEAKS ONSTAGE AT "FEATURED SESSION: UNDERSTANDING THE ROLE OF AI IN RESHAPING THE FILM & TELEVISION INDUSTRY" DURING THE 2023 SXSW CONFERENCE AND FESTIVALS AT AUSTIN CONVENTION CENTER ON MARCH 14, 2023 IN AUSTIN, TEXAS.

IMAGE CREDITS:DIEGO DONAMARIA/GETTY IMAGES FOR SXSW

Writing the Future with AI?

[May Habib](#), co-founder and CEO, Writer

What happens when AI learns to write with purpose, personality, and persuasion? [Writer](#) CEO May Habib joins us to talk about the evolving relationship between language and machines and what the rise of generative content means for the future of brand, business, and beyond.

Why the Next Frontier Is Search

[Edo Liberty](#), founder and CEO, Pinecone

In a world overflowing with data, finding what matters is everything. [Pinecone](#) founder Edo Liberty unpacks why infrastructure, not algorithms, might be the biggest unlock in AI, and what's coming next in the race to power smarter applications at scale.

Intelligence in Motion and the Future of Physical AI

[Jeff Cardenas](#), co-founder and CEO, Apptronik; and [Raquel Urtasun](#), founder and CEO, Waabi

AI in the physical world hasn't had its ChatGPT moment... yet. [Waabi](#) CEO Raquel Urtasun and [Apptronik](#) CEO Jeff Cardenas join us to explore and demonstrate what it takes to bring intelligence into motion, whether it's behind the wheel or on two legs. From simulation to sensors to scaling safely, this panel explores the breakthroughs driving the next generation of physical machines.

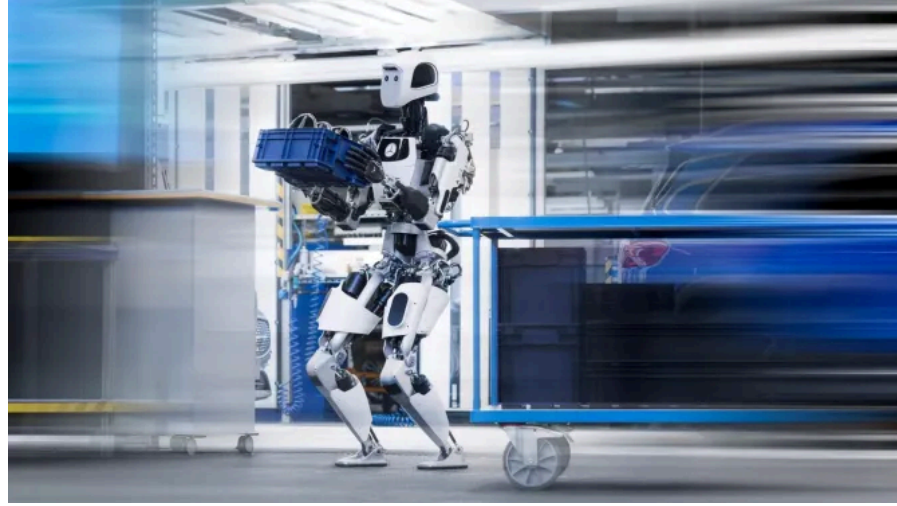


IMAGE CREDITS: APPTRONIK/MERCEDES

Building Intelligence for Modern Defense

[Ethan Thornton](#), founder and CEO, Mach Industries

From stealth mode to center stage, [Mach Industries](#) is bringing AI into one of the world's most complex and controversial sectors: defense. CEO Ethan Thornton joins us to talk about what it takes to build in high-stakes environments, where speed and autonomy matter most, and why next-gen infrastructure starts with rethinking the fundamentals.

Driving Intelligence

[Alex Kendall](#), co-founder and CEO, Wayve

From self-driving cars to self-learning systems, Alex Kendall is rethinking how machines perceive and act in the world. The [Wayve](#) CEO joins us to explore how real-world autonomy is shaping the next chapter of AI, and why breakthroughs on the road may unlock progress far beyond it.

From Ads to Films: Creating with Code

[Alejandro Matamala Ortiz](#), co-founder and chief design officer, Runway

Creatives aren't being replaced, they're being rearmed. Alejandro Matamala Ortiz, co-founder of [Runway](#), shares how creative work is being reshaped by machine learning, what AI-native tools mean for visual storytelling, and why this is just the beginning of a new creative era.

Shaping the AI Stack

[Thomas Wolf](#), co-founder and CSO, Hugging Face

From models and datasets to ethics and infrastructure, [Hugging Face](#) is helping define what building responsibly with AI actually looks like. Co-founder and CSO Thomas Wolf joins us to talk about the shifting power dynamics in the AI ecosystem, the rise of community-led innovation, and what it takes to stay open while moving fast.

Synthetic Voices and Real Impact

[Mati Staniszewski](#), co-founder and CEO, ElevenLabs

From audiobooks to avatars, synthetic speech is having a moment. [ElevenLabs](#) is helping lead the charge. CEO Mati Staniszewski joins us to explore what it takes to build AI that speaks like us and how voice technology is reshaping the creative industries, accessibility, and entertainment.



MATI STANISZEWSKI SPEAKS ONSTAGE DURING “THE AI VOICE REVOLUTION” PANEL DISCUSSION ON DAY THREE OF SXSW LONDON 2025 AT THE TRUMAN BREWERY ON JUNE 4, 2025 IN LONDON, ENGLAND.

IMAGE CREDITS: JEFF SPICER/GETTY IMAGES FOR SXSW LONDON

Love, Lies, & Algorithms: The Truth about AI in Matters of the Heart

[Mark Kantor](#), head of product and Innovation, Match Group; [Eugenia Kuyda](#), CEO, Replika; and more speakers to be announced.

AI is changing the way we meet, match, and fall in love, sometimes in ways we don’t even notice. This panel explores how technology is reshaping modern relationships, for better or worse. From dating apps to digital soulmates, we’ll look at where things are headed and what that means for the human heart.

AI and National Security in the High-Stakes Race to Innovate

[Sri Chandrasekar](#), managing partner, Point72; [Justin Fanelli](#), CTO, The Navy; and [Kathleen Fisher](#), director, DARPA

From defense labs to Wall Street and naval operations, AI is reshaping how countries protect themselves and project power. [DARPA](#)’s Kathleen

Fisher, [Point72](#)'s Sri Chandrasekar, and Navy CTO Justin Fanelli dive into the cutting-edge AI breakthroughs driving security innovation. They'll discuss what it means for entrepreneurs, investors, and the future of global stability.

Step into the future of AI at Disrupt 2025

Don't miss your chance to be part of the conversation shaping the future of AI at [TechCrunch Disrupt 2025](#). For over two full days, the [AI Stage](#) will feature nonstop sessions with visionary founders, top VCs, and industry leaders — alongside four other cutting-edge stages: Space, Builders, Going Public, and Disrupt — from October 27 to 29 in San Francisco's Moscone West.

[Secure your ticket now](#) to save up to \$675 before prices rise after July, and get ready to unlock the next wave of AI innovation redefining technology, creativity, security, and much more.



IMAGE CREDITS:KIMBERLY WHITE FOR TECHCRUNCH / GETTY IMAGES

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AI



Where AI meets design: Runway co-founder Alejandro Matamala Ortiz takes the AI Stage at TechCrunch Disrupt 2025

TechCrunch Events — 3:45 PM PDT · July 10, 2025

[TechCrunch Disrupt 2025](#) is the epicenter where 10,000+ startup and VC leaders gather to explore the future of innovation — and this year, two AI Stages bring the intersection of design and machine learning into sharp focus.

We're thrilled to welcome [Alejandro Matamala Ortiz](#), co-founder and chief design officer at Runway, to one of the AI Stages at Disrupt 2025, taking place October 27–29 in San Francisco. As part of a can't-miss panel conversation, Ortiz will share how design principles are guiding the next generation of generative AI tools — and how his team at [Runway](#) is redefining what creativity looks like in the age of machines.

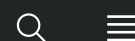


Why attend this session?

Expect fresh, actionable insights into how creative professionals and technologists can work together to build tools that empower — not replace — human

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[Madelyn Stages](#) at Disrupt 2025 to hear from Matamala Ortiz and other leaders who are building the creative engines of tomorrow. [Buy your ticket now and save up to \\$625.](#)

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The votes are in:
TechCrunch Disrupt 2025
Audience Choice winners

revealed for roundtables and breakouts

TechCrunch Events — 7:30 AM PDT · July 14, 2025



You voted — they made it onto the [TechCrunch Disrupt 2025](#) agenda!

After reviewing hundreds of standout Call for Content submissions and opening the vote to the TechCrunch audience, we've locked in the top five roundtables and top five breakout sessions.

Without further ado, meet the exceptional tech voices — and the sessions they'll lead — that will shape the conversation at Disrupt 2025, taking place October 27-29 at San Francisco's Moscone West. [Visit the agenda page](#) for full session and speaker details.

[Grab your ticket now and save up to \\$675 before prices increase.](#)

Breakout session winners

From Vibes to Velocity: How AI Tools Can Help You Achieve Your Development Goals



[Tim Rogers](#)

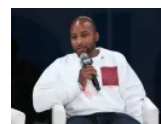
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FUNDRAISING



How to actually raise a seed round: Actionable advice from top investors at TechCrunch Disrupt 2025

TechCrunch Events
- 13 hours ago

STARTUPS



Figma's IPO success is 'a little bit of a meme stock,' says Sapphire Ventures' Jai Das

Rebecca Bellan,
Theresa Loconsolo
- 16 hours ago

With vibe coding on the rise, devs are looking to move faster and ship smarter. In this breakout, GitHub PM Tim Rogers dives into Copilot — the AI-powered peer programming tool used by more than 15 million — and how it's reshaping workflows in an autonomous world.

How to Get Acquired in Tech (Without Selling Out): M&A Tips for Founders and Builders



[Akil Ibssa](#)

Head of Corporate Development and M&A
Coinbase

Coinbase just pulled off crypto's biggest acquisition. In this no-BS session, learn how to make your project irresistible — from product-market fit to community traction — and position for M&A, investment, or partnership without compromising decentralization. If you're an investor, you'll get a cheat sheet for spotting teams building toward high-value outcomes.

AI at the Brink: Strategic Playbook for National Security



[Daniel Hendrycks](#)

Executive Director
Center for AI Safety (CAIS)

STARTUPS



Payment platform Lava raises \$5.8M to build digital wallets for the 'agent-native economy'

Dominic-Madori Davis
- 16 hours ago

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Advanced AI brings risks like bioweapons and cyberattacks amid global competition. This session explores strategic frameworks for AI safety, covering technical checks, non-proliferation, and supply chain security with Dan Hendrycks and key experts.



Tech and VC heavyweights join the Disrupt 2025 agenda

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Embracing AI for a Better Digital Future



[Matt Madrigal](#)

Chief Technology Officer
Pinterest

AI is at a crossroads, shaping whether it is additive or addictive, inclusive or harmful. Matt shows how Pinterest uses AI for positivity, personalization, and productivity, offering a responsible approach that drives innovation while prioritizing user well-being.

Agentic AI for Startups: Automate, Adapt, and Accelerate Growth



[Anmol Rastogi](#)

Head of Product Management, AI & ML
Amazon Business Amazon

Agentic AI is transforming startups by enabling automation, personalized experiences, and data-driven agility. This session covers identifying AI opportunities, building workflows, and measuring impact using real case studies to help founders accelerate growth and outpace competition.

Roundtable session winners

The Winning Formula: Turning Your Business Into a Trusted, Scalable Community To Drive Growth



[Justine Palefsky](#) and [Tasneem Amina](#)

Co-Founders

Kindred

Join Kindred co-founders Justine Palefsky and Tasneem Amina as they reveal how they transformed home swapping into a community-led movement. Learn their blueprint for building trust, turning members into ambassadors, and driving growth through authentic, values-driven community building.

How to Train Your Model: Taming AI Agents Without Breaking Them



[Kyla Guru](#)

Head of Model Cyber Safety
Anthropic

This interactive session dives into balancing AI safety and usefulness, covering constitutional AI, red-teaming, and steering methods. Attendees will gain frameworks and strategies to build AI models that are both helpful and harmless without losing personality.

Future of Space Economy in the Low Earth Orbit



[Abhi Kumar](#)

Lecturer, Investor, and Advisor
UC Berkeley

Low Earth Orbit (LEO) is evolving beyond satellites into manufacturing, energy, and data

infrastructure. This session covers the emerging LEO economy, regulations, and investments, offering insights on partnering with space startups and leveraging orbital platforms for Earth industries.

Scaling Search and AI for Millions: Lessons from Reddit Search



[Rachel Miller](#)

Product Manager
Reddit

Explore how Reddit builds AI at scale, balancing relevance, safety, and bias for millions of users. This session tackles community expectations, ethical tradeoffs, and real-world challenges, inviting startups to join a candid discussion on trusted AI development.

AI Evaluation 101: Addressing Challenges to Real-World AI Applications



[Rohit Patel](#)

Director, Meta Superintelligence Labs
Meta

This session breaks down how neural networks generate language and the challenges of deploying GenAI. Learn why evaluation matters and compare automated, judge-based, and human-rated

methods to build tests that measure AI versus human performance for your use case.

Join these sessions — and much more — live at Disrupt 2025

These 10 sessions are just a glimpse of the 250+ speakers and talks at Disrupt. Keep an eye on the [agenda page](#) for new updates, and [grab your ticket now](#) to save up to \$675 before prices rise.

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